



FLEET & SHORE PERSONNEL TRAINING

Steward Training

Accommodation hygiene, guest and crew service standards, laundry and linen management, and the safety and welfare requirements that govern life onboard.

MLC 2006

ISM Code

Company SMS

STCW

What We Will Cover

01

Role of the Steward Department

Responsibilities, standards and the chain of accountability

02

Accommodation Hygiene Standards

Cleaning routines, cabins, galleys and public spaces

03

Guest & Crew Service Standards

Professional conduct, catering and mess service

04

Laundry & Linen Management

Handling, washing, storage and stock control

05

MLC 2006 Accommodation Requirements

Minimum standards for space, welfare and inspection

06

Safety in Accommodation Spaces

Fire doors, escape routes and fire prevention

07

Pest Control & Chemical Safety

Safe handling of cleaning chemicals and pest management



SECTION 1

Role of the Steward Department

01

Why the standard of the accommodation and catering service reflects directly on the Company and on the ship's ISM Code performance.

What the Steward Department Delivers

The steward department is responsible for the welfare, hygiene and comfort of everyone living and working aboard the ship.

- The Chief Steward (or catering officer) reports to the Master and is responsible for catering, accommodation hygiene, laundry and stores under their charge.
- Duties cover crew and officer messrooms, cabins, galleys, pantries, laundries, public spaces and, on passenger and offshore vessels, guest accommodation.
- Standards are set by the Company SMS, MLC 2006, flag-state health regulations and, where relevant, port health and food-safety authorities.
- Poor accommodation hygiene or catering standards are a leading cause of MLC 2006 deficiencies found during Port State Control inspections.
- The department directly affects crew welfare, morale and retention — a well-run mess and clean accommodation measurably reduce fatigue-related incidents.



Daily Discipline

Every steward follows a written daily/weekly cleaning and service schedule — consistency, not effort on inspection day alone, is what keeps standards genuinely high.

TEAM STRUCTURE

Roles Within the Department

A clear division of duties keeps catering, cleaning and laundry running to schedule.



Chief Steward

Plans menus and cleaning schedules, manages stores and budget, and reports standards and deficiencies to the Master.



Cook / Chief Cook

Prepares meals to the agreed menu, maintains galley hygiene, and manages food stock rotation and temperature control.



Messman / Steward

Serves meals, cleans messrooms and cabins, and reports any accommodation defect (leak, faulty lock, damaged fitting) promptly.



Laundryman

Operates the laundry, manages linen stock and rotation, and follows correct wash cycles for different fabric types.



SECTION 2

Accommodation Hygiene Standards

02

The routines and standards that keep cabins, galleys and public spaces clean, safe and free of health hazards.

GENERAL STANDARDS

Maintaining a Hygienic Ship

Hygiene standards apply across every space crew live in, eat in or pass through.

- Cabins, alleyways, stairways, messrooms and recreation spaces are cleaned to a documented schedule, not only before inspections or audits.
- Galleys and pantries follow food-safety hygiene rules in addition to general cleaning: work surfaces, cutting boards and equipment are sanitised between uses.
- Waste is segregated, stored in covered containers, and disposed of in line with the ship's Garbage Management Plan and MARPOL Annex V.
- Ventilation, drainage and refrigeration in accommodation and galley spaces are checked regularly to prevent mould, odours and food spoilage.
- Any sign of leaking pipework, damp or standing water is reported immediately — these conditions quickly become health and pest hazards.



Inspection Ready

A ship that is genuinely clean every day passes an unannounced PSC or internal audit without a special effort — that is the real test of a hygiene programme.

CLEANING FREQUENCY

Typical Accommodation Cleaning Schedule

Exact frequencies follow the Company's own SMS cleaning checklist, but the pattern below is standard across the fleet.

Area	Task	Minimum Frequency
Cabins	Vacuum, dust, change linen, bin emptied	Weekly / on turnover
Messrooms & pantries	Wipe surfaces, sanitise tables, mop floors	Daily, after each meal
Galley	Full deep clean of surfaces, extraction hoods and drains	Daily, plus scheduled deep clean
Alleyways & stairways	Sweep, mop, check handrails and non-slip strips	Daily
Public/recreation spaces	Dust, vacuum, sanitise shared equipment	Daily to weekly

GOOD PRACTICE

Everyday Hygiene Discipline

Small habits, followed consistently, prevent the majority of accommodation hygiene deficiencies.



Do

- Use colour-coded cloths and mops to avoid cross-contamination between galley, cabin and toilet areas
- Air cabins and drying rooms regularly to control humidity and prevent mould
- Report any pest sighting, leak or blocked drain to the Chief Steward the same day
- Keep cleaning chemicals in their original, labelled containers, stored separately from food



Don't

- Don't use the same cloth or mop across galley, toilet and cabin spaces
- Don't store personal items, oily rags or flammable material in escape routes or alleyways
- Don't mix cleaning chemicals together — some combinations release toxic gas
- Don't leave food waste or wet rubbish in accommodation bins overnight



SECTION 3

Guest & Crew Service Standards

Professional conduct, catering quality and mess service that reflect the Company's standards to every person aboard.

03

Service Standards Onboard

Whether serving fellow crew, officers, or visiting guests and superintendents, the same standard of professionalism applies.

- Staff present themselves in clean, complete uniform, observe basic food-handling hygiene (handwashing, no jewellery in the galley) and remain courteous at all times.
- Meal times, menus and any special dietary requirements are communicated clearly and respected, including religious, medical and allergen considerations.
- Messroom and cabin service is carried out discreetly and without disrupting rest hours, watchkeeping schedules or off-duty crew.
- Guests, superintendents, pilots and surveyors aboard are given the same standard of accommodation care and courtesy as senior officers.
- Complaints or special requests are logged and passed to the Chief Steward, who follows up to confirm the matter was resolved.



First Impressions

For a visiting superintendent, auditor or new crew member, the mess and accommodation are often the first thing they judge the ship's overall standards by.

Food Safety Fundamentals

Every steward and cook applies the same core food-safety principles at every meal.



Personal Hygiene

Handwashing before handling food, clean uniform, no working while unwell with symptoms of gastrointestinal illness.



Temperature Control

Hot food kept above 63°C, cold food below 5°C, and core temperatures checked and logged for high-risk items.



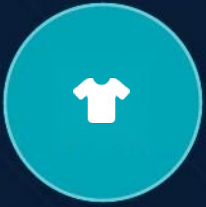
Cross-Contamination Control

Separate boards, utensils and storage for raw meat, fish, poultry and ready-to-eat food.



Stock Rotation (FIFO)

First-in, first-out stock rotation with clear date labelling to prevent spoiled or expired food being served.



SECTION 4

Laundry & Linen Management

Handling, washing and stock control that keeps linen, uniforms and workwear clean, hygienic and available.

04

Running a Safe, Efficient Laundry

The laundry handles bedding, towels, uniforms, tablecloths and crew personal laundry to a consistent standard.

- Laundry is sorted by fabric type, colour and soil level before washing, with heavily soiled or contaminated items (e.g. engine-room rags) kept fully separate.
- Wash cycles, water temperature and detergent dosing follow the equipment manufacturer's guidance and the fabric care labels on linen and uniforms.
- Dryers and ducting are cleaned of lint regularly — lint build-up is a recognised fire hazard in shipboard laundries.
- Ironing and pressing equipment is used only by trained crew, switched off and unplugged when not attended, and kept clear of flammable material.
- Personal protective equipment (heat-resistant gloves, apron) is worn when handling hot equipment or when using laundry chemicals.



Lint Is a Fire Risk

Dryer lint traps and exhaust ducting must be cleaned after every load — accumulated lint is highly combustible and a recurring cause of shipboard laundry fires.

STOCK CONTROL

Managing Linen Inventory

A well-managed linen store keeps enough stock on hand without over-ordering or wastage.

3x

Typical minimum linen sets held per bunk — one in use, one in wash, one in reserve

FIFO

New linen stock is issued last, so older stock is used and replaced first

100%

Of damaged or worn-out linen is logged and reported before disposal or replacement



SECTION 5

MLC 2006 Accommodation Requirements

The Maritime Labour Convention's minimum standards for accommodation, welfare and how they are inspected.

05

What MLC 2006 Requires

The Maritime Labour Convention, 2006, Regulation 3.1 sets binding minimum standards for accommodation and recreational facilities.

- Accommodation must be adequate in size, properly constructed and maintained, with sound and vibration levels, heating, ventilation and lighting to a reasonable standard.
- Minimum requirements cover cabin floor area per person, headroom, bedding, sanitary facilities, and separate messroom and recreation space provision.
- Hospital/medical spaces, where required by ship size, must be kept clean, properly ventilated and stocked in line with the ship's medical guide.
- Sanitary facilities (toilets, washbasins, showers) must be provided in sufficient number, kept clean and in good working order at all times.
- The Maritime Labour Certificate and Declaration of Maritime Labour Compliance (DMLC) confirm the ship meets these standards and are checked at every PSC inspection.



Master's Inspection Duty

MLC 2006 requires the Master (or a person appointed by the Master) to carry out regular inspections of accommodation to ensure it is clean, decently habitable and in good repair.

How Accommodation Compliance Is Checked

MLC 2006 builds inspection into daily routine, not just periodic surveys.

Inspection	Carried Out By	Typical Interval
Weekly accommodation inspection	Master or appointed officer	At least weekly
Internal SMS audit	Company DPA / auditor	As per SMS schedule
Flag-state / classification survey	Flag state or RO surveyor	Periodic, per certificate
Port State Control (PSC)	Port state inspector	At port calls

COMMON FINDINGS

Frequent MLC Accommodation Deficiencies

Awareness of these recurring PSC findings helps the steward department stay ahead of them.



Poor Cleanliness

Dirty galleys, cabins or sanitary spaces — the single most common MLC accommodation deficiency recorded worldwide.



Inadequate Ventilation / Heating

Faulty air conditioning, heating or ventilation left unreported and unrepaired.



Damaged Fittings

Broken furniture, fittings or fixtures in cabins and messrooms not reported through the defect list.



Poor Food Stock Management

Expired or improperly stored provisions found during galley and store inspections.



SECTION 6

Safety in Accommodation Spaces

Fire doors, escape routes and everyday fire prevention that protect the spaces crew sleep and relax in.

06

Why Accommodation Is a Fire Priority

SOLAS Chapter II-2 treats accommodation as a high-priority fire zone because it is where crew are most vulnerable — asleep or off-guard.

- Self-closing fire doors in accommodation must never be wedged, propped or tied open — this is one of the most frequently cited PSC deficiencies.
- Escape routes and stairways are kept permanently clear of stores, laundry trolleys, rubbish and any other obstruction, day and night.
- Smoke detectors and sprinkler heads in cabins and public spaces must never be covered, painted over or have anything hung from them.
- Ironing equipment, kettles and other electrical appliances used by stewards are switched off and unattended items unplugged after use.
- Smoking is permitted only in designated areas — never in cabins, bedding stores or laundries — under the ship's smoking policy.



Wedged Doors Kill

A fire door held open with a wedge or rope defeats its entire purpose — in an accommodation fire it can be the difference between containment and a rapidly spreading blaze.

Keeping Escape Routes Usable

Every steward has a direct role in keeping accommodation escape routes ready for immediate use.



Do

- Keep alleyways, stairwells and escape hatches completely clear at all times
- Report any fire door that does not close and latch properly
- Keep muster lists, deck plans and escape route signage visible and undamaged
- Store laundry trolleys and cleaning equipment only in designated storage spaces



Don't

- Don't wedge, tie back or disable any self-closing fire door
- Don't leave trolleys, bins or stores in alleyways, even temporarily
- Don't cover, paint or hang items from smoke detectors or sprinkler heads
- Don't store flammable material (aerosols, chemicals, rags) in cabins or escape routes



SECTION 7

Pest Control & Chemical Safety

Preventing infestation and handling cleaning chemicals safely, following COSHH-style risk assessment.

07

Keeping the Ship Pest-Free

Pests aboard are a health hazard, a food-safety risk and a common cause of PSC detention on some trades.

- Food stores, galleys and pantries are kept sealed, dry and free of spillage — the most effective pest control is removing food and moisture sources.
- Any sighting of insects, rodents or evidence of infestation (droppings, gnaw marks) is reported immediately to the Chief Steward and logged.
- The ship's Deratting Certificate (or Deratting Exemption Certificate) must be valid and kept with the ship's certificates; port authorities check it on arrival.
- Pesticides and rodenticides are used only by trained personnel, following label instructions, and stored securely away from food and accommodation.
- New stores are inspected on delivery for signs of contamination or infestation before being struck down into the ship's stores.

COSHH-Style Handling of Cleaning Chemicals

Control of Substances Hazardous to Health principles apply to every cleaning chemical carried for accommodation and galley use.



Assess Before Use

Every cleaning chemical has a Safety Data Sheet (SDS) on board; read it before first use to understand hazards, PPE and first-aid measures.



Store, Label and Segregate Correctly

Chemicals stay in original, labelled containers, stored away from food, and incompatible chemicals (e.g. bleach and acid-based descaler) are kept apart.

Using Cleaning Chemicals Safely

Following the label and the SDS every time prevents the majority of chemical exposure incidents.



Do

- Wear the PPE specified on the label or SDS — gloves and eye protection as a minimum
- Ventilate the space being cleaned, especially when using strong disinfectants
- Dilute chemicals exactly as instructed, using the correct measuring equipment
- Wash hands thoroughly after handling any cleaning chemical



Don't

- Don't mix different cleaning chemicals, especially bleach with ammonia or acid products
- Don't decant chemicals into unlabelled or food/drink containers
- Don't use chemicals in an unventilated or enclosed space
- Don't skip the SDS because the chemical 'looks the same' as one you already know



COURSE COMPLETE

A clean, well-run ship starts with the standards the steward department sets every single day.

Company DPA — 24/7 emergency line

Fleet Technical Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr

Fleet Safety Department — mng@gloryship.com.tr